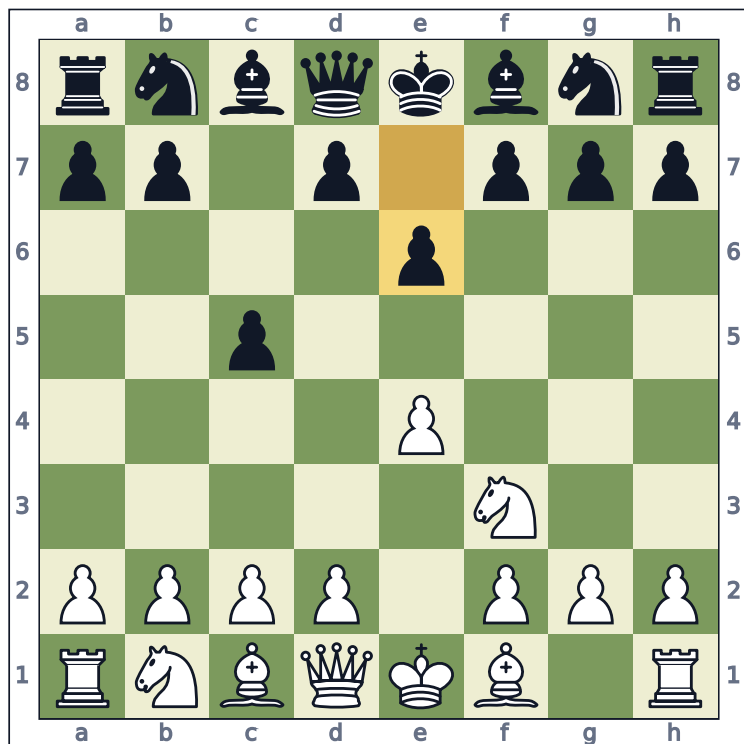


## SICILIAN DEFENSE

# Sicilian Defense

ECO B40 | 18 named lines in this code



*Featured opening position - gold marks the last move*

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.57 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B40 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: French Variation.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

**PIECE MAP**

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named B40 line

This section preserves all 18 names and defining routes assigned to B40 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001 Sicilian Defense: Alapin Variation, Sherzer Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c3 Nf6 4. e5 Nd5 5. d4 Nc6

**002 Sicilian Defense: Delayed Alapin Variation, with e6**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c3

**003 Sicilian Defense: Drazic Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 a6

**004 Sicilian Defense: French Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6

**005 Sicilian Defense: French Variation, Normal**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6

**006 Sicilian Defense: French Variation, Open**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4

**007 Sicilian Defense: French Variation, Westerinen Attack**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. b3

**008 Sicilian Defense: Gaw-Paw Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Qb6

**009 Sicilian Defense: Kan Variation, Wing Attack, Fianchetto Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. Nc3 a6 4. g3 b5 5. d4 cxd4 6. Nxd4

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named B40 line

This section preserves all 18 names and defining routes assigned to B40 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**010 Sicilian Defense: Kramnik Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c4

**011 Sicilian Defense: Kveinis Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Qb6

**012 Sicilian Defense: Marshall Counterattack**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 d5

**013 Sicilian Defense: Paulsen-Basman Defense**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Bc5

**014 Sicilian Defense: Pin Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Bb4

**015 Sicilian Defense: Pin Variation, Jaffe Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Bb4 6. Bd3 e5

**016 Sicilian Defense: Pin Variation, Koch Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Bb4 6. e5

**017 Sicilian Defense: Smith-Morra Gambit Deferred**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. c3

**018 Sicilian Defense: Wing Gambit Deferred**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. b4